

MS WORD ESSENTIALS · CHAPTER SERIES

# MS Word Essentials

Chapter 4 · Paragraph Formatting



# Course Roadmap — 20 Chapters

MS Word Essentials · Guided practice every chapter, full assignment every 4

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▲ TODAY

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# Recap: Chapter 3

1

## Bold, Italic, Underline = B, I, U

Three simple shortcuts cover most of the emphasis you will ever need.

2

## Font Choice Sets the Tone

Serif fonts feel formal and traditional. Sans-serif fonts feel modern and clean on screen.

3

## Use Color Sparingly

Font color and highlighting work best when reserved for the few things that truly matter.

4

## Ctrl+Spacebar Resets Everything

When formatting gets messy, clearing it and starting fresh is often the fastest fix.

## Preview

# Today's Objectives

**1**

## Align Paragraphs Cleanly

Choose left, center, right, or justify so every paragraph sends the right visual signal.

**2**

## Control Line & Paragraph Spacing

Adjust the space inside and around paragraphs so pages feel open, not cramped.

**3**

## Indent Paragraphs Properly

Use first-line, hanging, and side indents to show structure at a glance.

**4**

## Add Borders & Shading

Frame or shade a paragraph to make one important block stand out.

# Paragraph Alignment

1

## Left Align (Ctrl+L)

The default alignment — text lines up neatly along the left margin, ragged on the right.

2

## Center Align (Ctrl+E)

Centers each line — best for titles, headings, and short standalone text.

3

## Right Align (Ctrl+R)

Lines up along the right margin — useful for dates, signatures, or captions.

4

## Justify (Ctrl+J)

Stretches text so both edges line up straight, like a newspaper column.

# Line & Paragraph Spacing

1

## Line Spacing

This controls the gap between lines in a paragraph. Common choices are 1.0, 1.5, and 2.0.

2

## Space Before & After

Adds breathing room above or below a whole paragraph, without touching the lines inside it.

3

## The Spacing Button

Home tab → Line and Paragraph Spacing icon — the fastest way to change both settings at once.

4

## Why It Matters

Consistent spacing is what separates a tidy, readable document from a cluttered one.

# Indents

1

## First-Line Indent

Pushes just the first line of a paragraph inward — the classic paragraph-opening style.

2

## Hanging Indent

Pushes every line except the first — common in bibliographies and reference lists.

3

## Left & Right Indent

Moves an entire paragraph inward from both margins — useful for setting off a quote.

4

## Increase / Decrease Indent

Home tab buttons, or drag the ruler markers — the fastest way to nudge a paragraph in or out.

# Borders & Shading

1

## Paragraph Border

Draws a line around a paragraph — useful for highlighting a notice or callout box.

2

## Shading

Fills the paragraph background with a light color — pairs well with a border.

3

## Borders and Shading Dialog

Home tab → Borders dropdown → Borders and Shading... for full control over style, color, and width.

4

## Use Sparingly

A bordered paragraph draws the eye — reserve it for the one thing that truly needs attention.



## PRACTICE

# Align a Class Notice

1

## Type the Notice

Type this notice, one line per line: “Certificate Distribution Ceremony” — “Friday, 25th July, 10:00 AM” — “Hunar Institute Main Hall, Dadu.”

2

## Center the Title

Select just the title line and press Ctrl+E — it should now sit in the middle of the page.

3

## Right-Align the Date

Select the date line and press Ctrl+R — it should now hug the right margin.

4

## Compare the Look

Left, centered, and right-aligned each look different. Notice how alignment changes how “official” a line feels.

## PRACTICE

# Fix the Spacing

1

## Select It All

Continue with your notice from the last slide — select the whole thing with Ctrl+A.

2

## Set 1.5 Line Spacing

Apply 1.5 line spacing — the notice should immediately feel less cramped.

3

## Add Space After the Title

Click into the title line and add 12pt space after — it should visibly push the date line down.

4

## Check the Difference

Toggle back to single spacing for a second. Then switch to 1.5 again. Can you see the difference?

## Wrap-Up

# Key Takeaways

**1**

## Alignment Sets the Tone

Left, center, right, and justify each send a different visual signal. Pick one on purpose.

**2**

## Spacing Improves Readability

Line spacing and paragraph spacing are two separate settings — both matter.

**3**

## Indents Show Structure

First-line and hanging indents signal different things — use the right one for the job.

**4**

## Borders Draw the Eye

A border or shading highlights a paragraph — but only works if used sparingly.

Next up — Chapter 5: Practice Assignment 1